Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Machine Learning Engineer – Customer Support AI role at Quillstone Payments. As a data scientist working across forecasting, churn modelling and experimentation, I have built and evaluated practical machine learning solutions and am looking to grow further on the production engineering side.

At Thistlebox, I developed a weekly LightGBM demand forecast that runs as a scheduled Vertex AI Workbench notebook and writes results to BigQuery for operations to use in Looker. The forecast improved WAPE from 23% to 14%, with an estimated 9% reduction in food waste. I also built a weekly-scored XGBoost churn model used to target retention offers; in a 10% holdout validation, churn decreased by 2.1 percentage points in the treated group. These projects have given me practical experience in feature engineering, model evaluation and scheduled data workflows.

I have also built a Streamlit application for planning and analysing sequential A/B tests, used by approximately 25 colleagues in product and growth. I wrote the app and Dockerfile, while the data platform team handled its Cloud Run deployment. Since 2025, I have added pytest unit tests for forecasting feature code, reaching approximately 60% coverage. I would bring this applied modelling and testing experience to a team integrating AI into merchant support, while continuing to develop my machine learning engineering skills alongside backend, data science and product colleagues.

Quillstone's focus on helping merchants get support quickly and without friction is a compelling setting for this work. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience could contribute to the Customer Operations AI team.

Kind regards,
Tobias Mwangi-Hartley